

Responsible AI & Digital Workplace Employee Policy Handbook

Company: Meridian Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

Policy Version: 2.1

Effective Date: 1 January 2026

Policy Owner: Human Resources & Information Security

Review Cycle: Annual

1. Purpose

This policy handbook establishes clear guidelines for the responsible use of artificial intelligence, company information, digital systems, workplace resources, attendance, leave, payroll, separation, and employee conduct.

The purpose of this policy is to encourage productive use of modern technology while protecting confidential information, employee privacy, company intellectual property, and business operations.

The policy is designed to promote fairness, transparency, security, and responsible decision-making across the organization.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all permanent, temporary, contractual, intern, and consultant employees of Meridian Technologies Pvt. Ltd., unless otherwise specified in an employment contract or project-specific agreement.

Employees working with customers, regulated information, or third-party systems may be subject to additional requirements.

Where another company policy imposes stricter requirements, the stricter requirement shall apply.

3. Responsible Use of Artificial Intelligence

Employees may use company-approved AI tools to improve productivity, generate drafts, summarize non-confidential information, assist with coding, analyze permitted datasets, and support routine business activities.

Employees must not enter confidential company information, customer personal information, passwords, authentication credentials, unreleased financial information, source code classified as restricted, or legally privileged material into publicly accessible AI systems.

AI-generated content must be reviewed by the employee before being used for business purposes.

Employees remain responsible for the accuracy, legality, and appropriateness of work produced with AI assistance.

3.1 Restricted AI Activities

The following activities require prior written approval from the Information Security or Legal team:

- Uploading confidential company documents to external AI services.
- Using AI to make employment, promotion, termination, compensation, or disciplinary decisions.
- Using customer personal information with an AI system.
- Deploying an AI-generated system directly into a production environment without appropriate technical review.
- Using AI to generate content that represents the company externally without human review.

3.2 AI Output Verification

AI systems may produce inaccurate, incomplete, outdated, biased, or fabricated information.

Employees must independently verify important factual claims before relying on AI-generated output for:

- Financial decisions.
- Legal or regulatory matters.
- Customer commitments.
- Security decisions.
- Employment decisions.
- Production system changes.

For high-impact decisions, AI output must be treated as advisory rather than as the final decision.

4. Company Data Classification

Company information is classified into four categories:

Classification	Examples	AI Usage
Public	Published website content, public announcements	Permitted
Internal	Internal procedures, general documentation	Approved company AI tools
Confidential	Customer information, contracts, business plans	Restricted
Highly Restricted	Credentials, encryption keys, sensitive personal data	Prohibited unless explicitly authorized

Employees must verify the classification of information before uploading, sharing, or processing it through external systems.

If classification is unclear, the information must be treated as **Confidential** until clarification is obtained.

5. Work Timings and Digital Attendance

Standard working hours are Monday to Friday, 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM, including a one-hour lunch break.

Saturdays and Sundays are weekly off days unless specific business requirements require otherwise.

Employees must record attendance through the Human Resource Management System or an approved biometric or web-based application.

Any late arrival exceeding fifteen minutes requires prior notification to the reporting manager.

Employees working remotely must remain available during agreed working hours and maintain their calendar status accurately.

Employees may take a sixty-minute lunch break and short tea or coffee breaks of ten to fifteen minutes in the morning and afternoon, provided these breaks do not adversely affect productivity or business operations.

Overtime requires prior manager approval. Approved overtime may be compensated through payment or compensatory time off, subject to applicable company rules.

Compensatory time off must normally be used within thirty days of accrual.

6. Leave Policy

Employees are entitled to the following categories of leave, subject to eligibility and applicable employment terms.

6.1 Annual / Earned Leave

Employees receive **24 days of Annual/Earned Leave per year**, credited monthly.

Unused earned leave may be carried forward up to a maximum balance of **15 days**.

Earned leave encashment is permitted upon separation from the company, subject to applicable rules.

6.2 Casual Leave

Casual Leave may be used for short-term personal requirements.

Employees should obtain approval from their reporting manager wherever reasonably practicable before taking casual leave.

6.3 Sick Leave

Sick Leave may be used when an employee is unable to work because of illness.

A medical certificate may be requested for extended periods of absence.

6.4 Compensatory Off

Employees who perform approved work on weekly offs or holidays may receive compensatory time off.

Such compensatory leave requires prior agreement or documented approval and should normally be used within thirty days.

7. Payroll and Salary Payments

Salaries are processed monthly and credited directly to employees' registered bank accounts on the last working day of the month.

Employees must immediately notify Human Resources in writing if their bank account or other payroll information changes.

Salary deductions may be made in accordance with applicable laws, statutory requirements, and company policy.

These may include statutory contributions, professional tax, approved recoveries, or other legally permitted deductions.

Employees should report payroll discrepancies to Human Resources within ten working days of receiving their salary.

8. Separation and Exit Process

Employees wishing to resign must submit their resignation in writing.

The applicable notice period shall be determined by the employee's employment contract.

During the notice period, employees are expected to:

- Complete or properly document pending work.
- Transfer relevant responsibilities.
- Return company property.
- Return or securely delete company information from personal devices where applicable.
- Complete required knowledge-transfer activities.
- Cooperate with reasonable exit-clearance requirements.

Final settlement may include pending salary, eligible leave encashment, approved reimbursements, recoveries, and other applicable amounts.

Final settlement will be processed after completion of the required clearance procedures.

9. Digital Security Responsibilities

Employees must protect company accounts, devices, and information.

Passwords must not be shared with colleagues or stored in unsecured documents.

Multi-factor authentication must be enabled wherever required by company security standards.

Employees must report suspected security incidents promptly.

Examples include:

- Lost company devices.
- Accidental disclosure of confidential information.
- Suspicious login notifications.

- Phishing messages.
- Unauthorized access.
- Accidental upload of restricted information to an external AI system.

Employees must not attempt to investigate or delete evidence of a suspected security incident unless instructed by the Information Security team.

10. Disciplinary Actions

Employees are expected to maintain professional conduct and comply with company policies.

Violations may result in disciplinary action depending on the nature and severity of the incident.

Potential actions may include:

- Informal counseling.
- Formal warning.
- Mandatory training.
- Temporary restriction of system access.
- Suspension where permitted by applicable rules.
- Termination of employment in serious cases.

Examples of serious violations may include intentional disclosure of confidential information, deliberate misuse of company systems, credential sharing, unauthorized access, falsification of records, or intentional misuse of AI systems.

Disciplinary decisions should consider the available evidence, applicable policies, severity of the conduct, and relevant employment terms.

11. AI Incident Reporting

Employees must promptly report suspected AI-related incidents to Information Security or Human Resources.

Examples include:

Scenario A: An employee accidentally uploads a confidential customer document to a public AI chatbot.

Required action: The employee should report the incident immediately and should not attempt to conceal or independently resolve the incident.

Scenario B: An employee discovers that an AI-generated report contains incorrect financial figures.

Required action: The report must be reviewed and corrected before being distributed or used for business decisions.

Scenario C: An employee uses an AI system to automatically reject job applicants without approved human-review controls.

Required action: The activity must be stopped and reported to the appropriate HR and Legal stakeholders.

12. Policy Exceptions

Exceptions to this policy require documented approval from the appropriate policy owner.

An employee must not assume that an activity is permitted simply because it is technically possible.

Exception requests should specify:

- The activity requiring an exception.
- Business justification.
- Information or systems involved.
- Duration of the exception.
- Potential risks.
- Proposed safeguards.

Approved exceptions may contain additional conditions or expiration dates.

13. Policy Version History

Version Effective Date Major Change			Owner
1.0	1 Jan 2025	Initial policy	HR
1.5	1 Jul 2025	Added digital security requirements	HR & Security

Version Effective Date Major Change			Owner
2.0	1 Jan 2026	Introduced responsible AI requirements	HR & Security
2.1	1 Mar 2026	Added AI incident and exception procedures	HR & Security

14. Employee Acknowledgement

I acknowledge that I have read and understood the Responsible AI & Digital Workplace Employee Policy Handbook.

I understand that I am responsible for complying with applicable company policies and reporting suspected violations or security incidents through the appropriate channels.

Employee Name: _____

Employee ID: _____

Department: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Document Control

Document Classification: Internal

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